

## 2.1. Before anything else: patch, patch, patch!

New vulnerabilities are constantly being discovered. Depending on the nature of the threat and its severity, Microsoft regularly releases security updates and patches for affected operating systems and application software. To ensure that the security update or patch is applied as soon as it is available, turn on Automatic Updates. To do that, open the Control Panel, click on System, and select the



Turn on Automatic Updates

Automatic Updates tab. Choose the first option to download the updates and get a notification when they are ready to be installed.

Other than operating system updates, Automatic Updates also downloads all high-priority updates for Microsoft Office XP, Microsoft

Office 2003, Microsoft SQL Server, and Microsoft Exchange Server. Note that if you use older versions of Office products, you will need to visit the Office Web site (<http://office.microsoft.com>) for the latest updates.

If you are interested, you can also subscribe to security bulletins via e-mail from Microsoft. These cater to both the home user as well as the technical professional. Go to [www.microsoft.com/technet/security/bulletin/notify.msp](http://www.microsoft.com/technet/security/bulletin/notify.msp) and subscribe to your choice of security information updates.